

PlayStation VR

A surge of virtual reality hardware is being observed in the market with companies presenting their best iteration of a VR headset and accessories. Originally called Project Morpheus, the first prototype of the PlayStation VR was revealed at GDC 2014. The PS VR will be available from October 2016, with a price tag of \$399 in the US, €399 in Europe, 44,980 Yen in Japan and £349 in the UK. The PS VR will run only on the PS4 and it has been priced way lower than the Oculus Rift and the HTC Vive – the Rift selling for \$599 while the Vive is going out for \$799. That's quite a price difference between them and although the PS VR isn't as powerful and you wouldn't need to spend big bucks on a powerful gaming rig to run the Oculus Rift or HTC Vive, which is great news for cash-strapped PC gamers.

There's another caveat albeit, the PlayStation VR pricing doesn't include the Move controllers nor the PlayStation Eye Camera. Users who'd want the complete experience will need to invest in these accessories which will end up costing the same as its other two prominent competitors. Sony expects about 50 games to be ready for the platform when it launches in October and around 230 developers have been working to build VR content for the platform.



SPECIFICATIONS

Display method: OLED | **Panel size:** 5.7 inches | **Panel resolution:** 1920 x RGB x 1080 (960 x RGB x 1080 per eye) | **Refresh rate:** 120Hz, 90Hz | **Field of view:** approximately 100 degrees | **Sensors:** accelerometer, gyroscope | **Connection interface:** HDMI, USB | **Latency:** less than 18ms | **Audio:** 3D audio with stereo mini jack and mic input



Dot

As far as smartwatches go, we've seen an entire host of devices from both small to big manufacturers and all of them have one thing in common – you need to be able to see the smartwatches to use them. But, not the Dot smartwatch. This timepiece is especially designed to aid the visually challenged user and features a braille interface. The Watch has been designed by a startup called Dot, in collaboration with SK Telecom. The aptly named Dot smartwatch features 30 raised pins, which display notifications in braille. The best part about braille notifications for the blind is that they no longer need to worry about the privacy issues that surface from the usual text-to-speech approach. The watch also comes with a seven day battery life, allowing for extended periods of use without the hassle of constant charging.

As far as usage is concerned, even though this is a niche category, the Dot watch may just be the first smartwatch which has real-world functionality. Also, a typical smartwatch mostly serves as an add-on to one's smartphone, but because of its braille notification feature, the Dot watch is a device that, if priced correctly, can make an actual difference. The Dot smartwatch is currently priced at \$290, which is a little on the expensive side. For now, the watch is in the prototype phase and the startup plans to go into mass production by October this year.